



PCMO
Project & Contracts Management Organisation

PCMO PODCASTS

Why Reliable Forecasts Require Honest Professional Judgement

Project Controls | Full episode transcript and learning guide

Episode overview

This PCMO episode examines why reliable forecasts require honest professional judgement through professional practice, decisions, controls, behaviours, and evidence.

Learning objectives

- Recognise why the issue matters.
- Identify practical controls and behaviours.
- Evaluate contextual factors.
- Select actions for further application.

Full discussion transcript

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Constructive challenge asks what is known, what remains assumed, which evidence is verifiable, what could change the conclusion, who can decide, and how the outcome will be monitored.

2. Progress evidence, remaining work, assumptions, dependencies, uncertainty, and risk must be connected

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3. Forecast confidence improves when teams can report difficult facts early without distortion

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4. Leaders should respond to adverse information with disciplined action rather than pressure to preserve an unsupported date

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Practical takeaways

- Define the data date and evidence rules.
- Separate actual progress from optimistic narrative.
- Document assumptions and sensitivity.
- Present ranges and confidence where appropriate.
- Connect corrective actions to forecast movement.

Reflection questions

1. Where does this issue appear in your environment?
2. Which control needs improvement?
3. What evidence would demonstrate progress?
4. Who should be involved?
5. What will you do in the next thirty days?

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